SARA SPAZIANI

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Academic Appointments

Assistant Professor of Economics, University of Warwick — August 2024–

Education

Ph.D. in Economics, Brown University — May 2024
Committee: John. N. Friedman, Peter Hull, Brian Knight

M.Sc. in Economics, Bocconi University, *Summa cum laude* — 2018

B.Sc. in Economics, Bocconi University, *Summa cum laude* — 2015

Exchange Program, Northwestern University — 2014

Affiliations

ROCKWOOL Foundation Berlin, Research Affiliate — 2025-

Institute of Fiscal Studies, Research Associate — 2025-

J-PAL Invited Researcher, Jobs and Opportunity Initiative — 2024-

AXA Research Lab on Gender Equality at Bocconi University External Fellow — 2024-

Publications

Alfonsi, L., Namubiru, M., Spaziani, S., 2023. "Gender Gaps: Back and Here to Stay? Evidence from Skilled Ugandan Workers during COVID-19". *Review of Economics of the Household.*

Spaziani, S., 2022. "Can Gender Quotas Break the Glass Ceiling? Evidence from Italian Municipal Elections". *European Journal of Political Economy.*

Working Papers

"Optimal Unemployment Insurance Financing: Theory and Evidence from Two U.S. States" *R&R, The Quarterly Journal of Economics*

"Meet Your Future: Experimental Evidence on the Labor Market Effects of Mentors"with Alfonsi L. and Namubiru M. *Conditionally accepted based on pre-results review, Journal of Development Economics. R&R, Journal of Political Economy.*

Selected Work in Progress

"Designing Severance Insurance: Theory and Evidence from Ethiopia".With G. Abebe, S. Caria, F. Gerard, and L. Hensel. *Conditionally accepted based on pre-results review. Journal of Development Economics.*

"Labor Market Effects of Incomplete Wage Taxation"With J. Gruber and A. Guo

"Women for Women? Public Response to Gender-Based Violence in Italy"With G. Conti, G. Facchini and F. Marazzi

Other Writing

"Technical Note on Taxable Wage Measures in Tennessee Administrative Data" (2026) [Note] [Replication]

"When the Great Equalizer Closes" G²LMLIC Policy Brief with L. Alfonsi and M. Namubiru (2021) [Link]

Fellowships and Awards

American Economic Journal: Economic Policy, Excellence in Reviewing Award	2025
Honorable Mention, W.E. Upjohn Institute for Employment Research Dissertation Award [Link]	2024
Honorable Mention, Outstanding Doctoral Dissertation in Government Finance and Taxation [Link]	2024
Runner-up, Doctoral Dissertation Prize, Associazione Italiana di Valutazione	2024
Etta Chiuri Prize, Società Italiana di Economia Pubblica [Link]	2023
Graduate Students Teaching Award, Brown University	2020, 2023
Merit Dissertation Fellowship, Brown University	2023
Stone Inequality Initiative Fellowship	2022
Graduate Program in Development Fellowship, Watson Institute of Public and International Affairs	2021
Distinction Letter, Northwestern University	2014

Grants

Orlando Bravo Center for Economic Research Award - $5,500	2021-2023
Watson Institute Graduate Program in Development Summer Funds -$3,000	2021, 2023
Economics Department Award, Brown University - $2,850	2020
JPAL Post Primary Initiative, Co-PI - $49,178	2020
IZA: Gender, Growth Labour Markets in LICs Programme, Co-PI - £9,149	2020

Research Presentations

2027 CES Public Economics Week Munich*

2026 ROCKWOOL Foundation Berlin, SEHO at University of Pavia, Diversity and Human Capital Workshop at Exeter, UPF*, SOFI*

2025 ENS Lyon, AXA Gender Lab at Bocconi, Bristol Applied Economics Meeting

2024 EIEF, Tor Vergata, CEMFI, UC Riverside, Warwick, IFS, IIES, Aix-Marseille School of Economics, Bank of Italy, UAB Economics and Economic History, UAB Applied Economics, Bilkent, EEA-ESEM, SIEP, AIEL, Brookings, NTA, Pittsburgh, APPAM, FROGEE and SITE Gender Conference

Pre- (2023): NTA, SIEP, Central Bank of Ireland, IIPF; (2022) NBER Behavioral Public Economics Bootcamp (attendee); (2021): NEUDC, LEAP-Bocconi Alumni Reunion

Professional Service

Referee: American Economic Review, American Economic Journal: Economic Policy, Economic Development and Cultural Change, Empirical Economics, European Journal of Political Economy, International Tax and Public Finance, Journal of Development Economics, Journal of Policy Analysis and Management, Journal of Population Economics, Oxford Bulletin of Economics and Statistics, Oxford Development Studies, Political Science Research and Methods, The Economic Journal

Grant Review: National Science Foundation

Conference Review: European Association of Young Economists Annual Meeting

Discussions: 2021: NEUDC; 2023: IIPF, 2024: NTA (invited), 2025: Workshop on Gender Equality at LSE (invited); GEP Labour and Globalisation Workshop on Firms, Workers and Inequality at Nottingham (invited); Stone Center Conference on Optimal Taxation and Policy Design at UCL (invited)

Dept. Service: *Warwick:* Working Group on Teaching Strategy, (2025-26), Junior Hiring (2024-25, 2026-27) Internal Examiner (2024-25, 2026-27)
Brown: Organizer of the Applied Micro Breakfast (2022-23, 2023-24)

Teaching

Instructor, University of Warwick

Principles of Political Economy: Economics and Politics - Undergraduate, PPE	2025, 2026
Topics in Micro and Public Economics - Undergraduate, Economics	2027
Public Economics - Graduate, Economics	2025, 2027

Teaching Assistant, Brown University

Mathematical Econometrics I - undergraduate, *(Professor: Peter Hull)*	2021, 2022
Microeconomics II - PhD Sequence, *(Professors: Kareen Rozen and Glenn Loury)*	2020
Designing Internet Marketplace - undergraduate *(Professor: Bobby Pakzad-Hurson)*	2019

Prior Employment and Affiliations

Population Studies and Training Center, Brown University, Affiliated Student	2019-2024
Watson Institute for International and Public Affairs, Brown University, Affiliated Student	2019-2024
Laboratory for Effective Anti-Poverty Policies, Bocconi University, Affilitated Student	2017-2024
IGIER, Bocconi University, Affiliated Student	2016-2018
Bocconi University, Research Assistant for Eliana La Ferrara	2017-2018
BRAC Uganda Research and Evaluation Unit, Field Assistant	2016
SEI Consulting, Intern	2015

Updated on October 19, 2026